

Rajesh Dammala

Observability / SRE / DevOps Tools Leader — Reliability & Developer Productivity

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<https://rdammala.github.io/LexisNexis-Observability-SRE-DevOps-Leader/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Observability, SRE, and DevOps-tooling leader with 12+ years across mission-critical platforms. Defines vision and standards for metrics, logs, traces, alerting, and SLI/SLO-based service health; owns governance of CI/CD and developer platforms (Azure DevOps, GitHub Enterprise, Jenkins); and manages infrastructure via Terraform. Drives incident excellence (RCA, post-mortems, on-call readiness), embeds observability across the software delivery lifecycle, and converts technical information into business value for stakeholders. Strong people leader who builds cultures of reliability, ownership, and continuous improvement.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

12+ Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering
100% SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services
30-35% Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation
25,000+ Stale Incidents Eliminated
85% → 98% Operational Efficiency Lift
15-32 Engineers Led Across Global Teams

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Architected AI-driven incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution across a 24/7/365 platform.
- Reduced resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency from 85% to 98% via observability and incident discipline.
- Eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts; cut alert fatigue ~90% through SLI/SLO-based alerting.
- Sustained 100% SLA across 20+ mission-critical services with early instrumentation and on-call readiness.
- Led and developed engineering teams of 15-32 across the US and India.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Observability: Metrics / Logs / Traces, SLI / SLO / Error Budgets, Dashboards & Alerting, OpenTelemetry (concepts), Datadog / Splunk / Grafana / New Relic (familiar), Kusto (KQL), Power BI, Azure Monitor / AppInsights

DevOps Tools & CI/CD: Azure DevOps, GitHub Enterprise / Git, Jenkins (familiar), Pipeline & Repo Governance, Build Agents & Integrations

Platform Engineering & IaC: Terraform, CloudFormation (concepts), Bicep / ARM, Configuration Standardization, Automation

Reliability & Incident: Incident Response, RCA & Post-Mortems, On-Call Readiness, Rollback &

Recovery, MTTR Reduction

Cloud: Microsoft Azure, AWS (concepts), Cloud-Native Architecture, Kubernetes (AKS/EKS)

Leadership & Security: Team Leadership (15-32), Access Controls & Auditability, Cost Optimization, Cross-functional Communication

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Observability (metrics/logs/traces, SLI/SLO) — **Expert**

Alerting & Dashboards (KQL/Power BI; Datadog/Grafana familiar) — **Advanced**

CI/CD & DevOps Tools (Azure DevOps, GitHub, Jenkins) — **Expert**

Infrastructure as Code (Terraform) — **Advanced**

Incident Response & RCA — **Expert**

Cloud-Native Architecture (Azure; AWS concepts) — **Advanced**

Engineering Team Leadership — **Expert**

Security, Compliance & Cost Governance — **Advanced**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead SRE & Observability / DevOps Tools Manager — Xbox Services

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present

Leads reliability, observability, and developer-tooling for a 24/7/365 mission-critical platform serving millions.

- Set observability direction — standards for metrics, logs, traces, alerting, dashboards, and SLI/SLO-based service health using Kusto (KQL), Power BI, and Azure Monitor/AppInsights.
- Owned DevOps tooling and CI/CD platforms (Azure DevOps, GitHub, build agents, pipelines); defined guardrails for repos, branching, and integrations.
- Drove incident excellence — RCA, post-mortems, detection, triage, rollback, recovery, and on-call readiness; reduced resolution time 32%.
- Managed platforms via Infrastructure as Code (Terraform); standardized configuration and operational practices to improve reliability and developer productivity.
- Architected AI-driven incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution; eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts.
- Partnered with Engineering, SRE/Operations, and Security to embed observability and operational excellence across the software delivery lifecycle.

Azure Platform & Reliability Technical Lead — Customer Support Services

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021

Led a 15-engineer team across cloud-native platform reliability and developer enablement.

- Hired, coached, and set priorities for a 15-engineer team; built a culture of reliability, ownership, and continuous improvement.
- Governed CI/CD and tooling standards (Azure DevOps, Git) including repos, branching, and pipeline guardrails.
- Drove reliability and incident response across cloud-native architectures; partnered with Security on access controls and auditability.
- Optimized platform spend and operational practices without degrading reliability or developer experience.

Operations Lead — Azure Live Site Observability

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016

Led 12 senior + 20 engineers operating cloud platforms at 99.95%+ SLA.

- Designed telemetry collection, dashboards, and alerting for 100+ services; promoted early instrumentation and SLI/SLO practices.
- Built PowerShell automation saving thousands of manual hours; standardized operational practices via Infrastructure as Code patterns.
- Led incident, problem, and change management; mentored engineers from specialists to technical leads.

Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

Infrastructure operations and monitoring across enterprise environments.

- Server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale migrations; deployed monitoring and patches.
- Scripted repetitive operational tasks to improve consistency and reduce manual effort.

SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

Observability Platform & SLI/SLO Standards — Defined org-wide standards for metrics, logs, traces, dashboards, and alerting with SLI/SLO-based service health, improving detection and developer productivity.

CI/CD & DevOps Tools Governance — Governed Azure DevOps/GitHub pipelines, repos, branching, and build agents with guardrails balancing capability, risk, and cost.

AI-Driven Incident Automation — Shipped an AI incident agent (30-35% auto-resolution) integrating telemetry and remediation workflows.

Platform-as-Code Standardization — Managed platforms via Terraform, standardizing configuration and operational practices to raise reliability.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations

- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

Reliability and developer productivity are two sides of the same coin: instrument early, alert on what matters (SLI/SLO), govern tooling with guardrails not gates, and turn every incident into durable improvement.